BRITISH COUNCIL

English Online

LIVE25

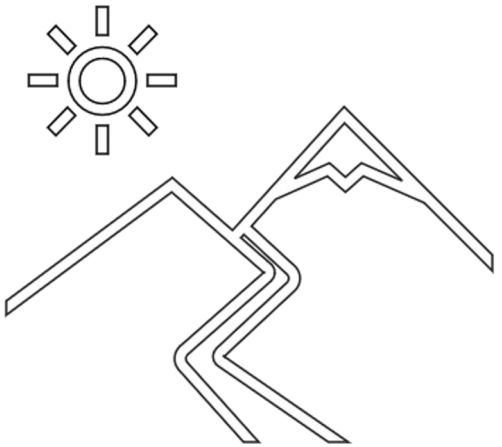
Pronunciation: intonation for rejecting and accepting invitations



Introduction

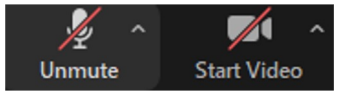
Welcome to Pronunciation Live25!

- **A new feature of English Online**
- **Free pronunciation presentations**
- **Download the PDF after booking**
- **Practise on mute**
- **Sit back and enjoy the ride!**



Please be on mute

You can keep your cams off



Lead-in

What would you say if I asked you:

"Would you like to go to the cinema with me this weekend? I want to see that new horror film!"

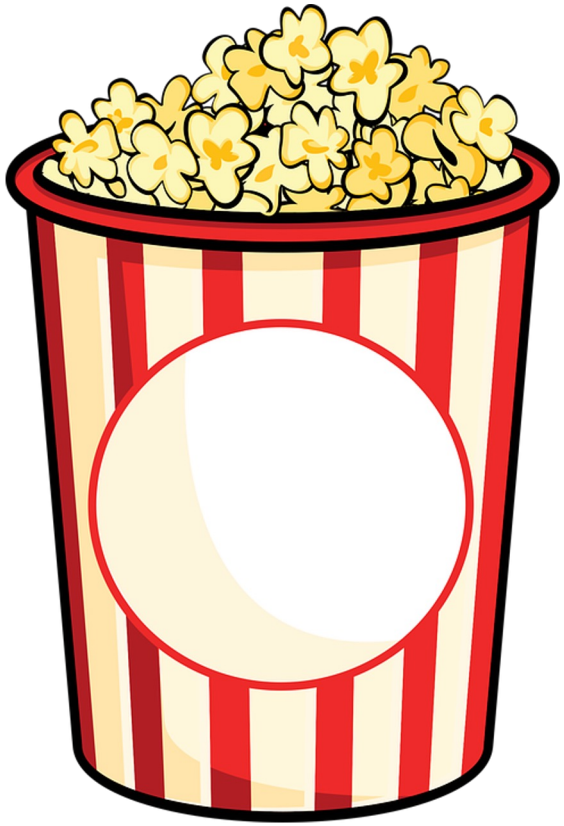
Not this weekend, I'm busy.

Yeah, sure!

Sorry, but horror films are not my cup of tea.

Oh, that would be nice.

That sounds great!



Let's focus

When we accept and reject offers, our voice does different things. Listen to my voice. Notice whether it rises ↗ or falls ↘ with each phrase.

Accepting an offer	Rejecting an offer
Yeah, sure!	Not this weekend, I'm busy.
That sounds great.	Sorry, but horror films aren't my cup of tea.
Oh, that would be nice.	

Form

English uses a pattern of rising and falling intonation. The intonation pattern depends on the type of sentence.

Accepting an offer (Rising ↗ Falling ↘)

Yeah ↗, sure↘

That ↗ sounds great ↘

Oh ↗ that would be nice ↘

I'd ↗ love to, I haven't seen one for ages↘

Great ↗ Let's go on Saturday ↘

Form

English uses a pattern of rising and falling intonation. The intonation pattern depends on the type of sentence.

Rejecting an offer (Falling ↘)

Not this weekend ↘, I'm busy ↘

Sorry ↘, but horror films aren't my cup of tea ↘

Oh ↘ I'd love to but ↘ ….

Not tomorrow ↘, there is something I have to do ↘

I've got to ↘ ….

Form

1. Do we use falling intonation to accept offers?

2. When do we use rising and falling intonation?

3. When do we use falling intonation?

Form

But what happens if you're not sure?

Hesitations (Falling ↘ Rising ↗)

So ↘ are you going to come with us ↗?

I'm not ↘ too sure ↗

I don't ↘ think I can come ↗

Erm ↘, yes. I think so ↗

Practice

Now we know the most common patterns, let's practice!

1. Accepting (Rising ↗ Falling ↘)
2. Rejecting (Falling ↘)
3. Hesitating (Falling ↘ Rising ↗)

Not tomorrow, I've got to…

That sounds great

Maybe, I need to check

I'm not too sure

Oh, I'd love to but..

Great, let's go on Saturday

Oh, that would be nice!

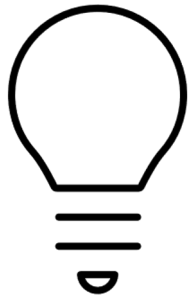
Key point

In English, our voice often goes up and down within a sentence or sometimes within a word. This is called intonation.

These are the most common intonation patterns for accepting and rejecting requests:

1. Accepting (Rising ↗ Falling ↘)
2. Rejecting (Falling ↘)
3. Hesitating (Falling ↘ Rising ↗)

Pronunciation tip:
These intonation patterns apply to different sentences too. For example, we use Rising ↗ Falling ↘ intonation for lists and Falling ↘ intonation for exclamations. Come to other Pron25 sessions to find out more!



Pronunciation Checkout

What intonation pattern would you use for these statements?

1. I've got a class at that time I'm afraid.

a) Falling ↘ **b) Rising –Falling ↗↘**

2. Great, I'll put it in my diary!

a) Rising- Falling ↗↘ **b) Falling- Rising ↘↗**

3. I don't know, I need to check with my partner.

a) Falling -Rising ↘↗ **b) Rising –Falling ↗↘**



Pronunciation Checkout - Answers

What intonation pattern would you use for these statements?

1. I've got a class at that time I'm afraid.

a) Falling ↘

2. Great, I'll put it in my diary!

Rising- Falling ↗↘

3. I don't know, I need to check with my partner.

a) Falling -Rising ↘↗



Thank you for attending this presentation!

Review the next few slides for lessons linked to this Live25 webinar.



https://learn-english-today.com/pronunciation-stress/intonation.html

If you’re an IELTS Coach student, now you’re ready for…



Speaking
Gifts: effective pronunciation

If you're an English Online student, now you're ready for…



Elementary
Theme: Experiences
Lesson: A day out

Pre-intermediate
Theme: Workplace skills
Lesson: Making arrangements

Intermediate
Theme: Business travel and socialising
Lesson: Making arrangements on the phone

Upper intermediate
Theme: Negotiations
Lesson: Getting the pay rise you deserve

Advanced
Theme: Travel, holidays and the environment
Lesson: Tourism

If you're an English for Work student, now you're ready for…



Elementary
Theme: At work
Lesson: Before a meeting

Pre-intermediate
Theme: Clients and colleagues
Lesson: Arranging to meet

Intermediate
Theme: Presentations
Lesson: Working together on projects

Upper intermediate
Theme: Changes of plan
Lesson: Discussing revised plans with a client

Advanced
Theme: People and events
Lesson: Negotiating